BUHLE PALAZA

Software Tester
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PROFILE

Software QA tester with a year of hands-on testing experience at CAPACITI across e-commerce, HR and payment systems. Experienced in manual testing, API validation, defect investigation and automated regression testing with Playwright, Selenium and pytest. Software development experience helps me investigate issues beyond the interface and collaborate effectively with developers. Seeking a QA Analyst or Software Tester role in an Agile/Scrum team, looking to grow my API testing and automation skills. Currently working towards ISTQB CTFL certification to strengthen my testing methodologies and skills. Open to relocation, remote and hybrid work.

SKILLS

Testing: Manual, functional, regression, integration, exploratory, usability and UAT; API testing; cross-browser and cross-device testing; performance and security checks; test planning, scenarios, cases, traceability and defect reporting.

Automation and tools: Playwright, Selenium WebDriver (Java/Python), TestNG, JUnit, pytest, Postman, Jira, ExtentReports, pytest-html and GitHub Actions.

Development: Python, Flask, SQLAlchemy, SQL, PostgreSQL, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP, Laravel, REST APIs, Git and GitHub.

EXPERIENCE

Software Tester Trainee - CAPACITI August 2025 - August 2026
Gqeberha | Hybrid contract

- Reviewed user stories, acceptance criteria and requirements to estimate testing effort and define test approaches, translating them into test plans, scenarios and regression packs in Jira with traceability.
- Executed manual, functional, integration, exploratory, performance and security checks across e-commerce, HR and payment systems, including cross-browser and cross-device testing.
- Performed backend and API testing with Postman and built, maintained and executed automated UI and backend regression suites using Playwright, Selenium WebDriver, JUnit and pytest.
- Identified, reproduced and logged defects in Jira with reproduction steps and evidence; performed retesting and regression checks to confirm fixes and obtain sign-off before closure.
- Worked in an Agile/Scrum team of 10, collaborating with developers and across departments, testing features during development and validating end-to-end workflows before deployment.
- Performed pre-launch QA and post-launch UAT spot checks to confirm release stability, and prepared documentation for team knowledge sharing.

Software Developer | Makwande Careers January 2025 - June 2025
Remote contract

- Architected, built and tested a career-services web application using Python, Flask, PostgreSQL and SQLAlchemy, with RESTful backend services and an HTML/CSS/JavaScript frontend.
- Delivered the business's first website and a centralised admin dashboard for enquiries, CV submissions and purchases, integrating Paystack payments and Resend transactional email.
- Implemented bcrypt password hashing, CSRF protection and input sanitisation; conducted end-to-end QA before go-live and configured GitHub Actions CI/CD with Render.
- Diagnosed and fixed membership submissions that appeared successful but were not saved to the database and resolved a file-upload field mismatch blocking CV/document uploads.
- Improved admin dashboard load times by using Promise.all to run independent requests in parallel.

Systems Developer Intern - Loomee Group September 2023 - August 2024
Gqeberha | Hybrid contract

- Collaborated in a development team to build Forgot Password ROI, a web application displaying advertisements and capturing product interest during password recovery, using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP and Laravel.
- Developed interactive forms for capturing product interest, email addresses and intended purchase dates, with fields displayed according to user selections.
- Implemented client-side validation using JavaScript and server-side validation using Laravel FormRequest rules.
- Contributed to password-reset and email workflows, tested form behaviour and navigation, investigated issues, and managed source code through GitHub.

EDUCATION

Diploma in Information Technology | Nelson Mandela University | Port Elizabeth | 2025
N2 Engineering Studies | Port Elizabeth College | 2019
National Senior Certificate (Matric) | Khumbulani High School | Port Elizabeth | 2018

TRAINING AND CERTIFICATIONS

Further Education and Training Certificate: Information Technology: System Development, MICT SETA - 2025
Software Testing - Coursera - 2025

- Foundations of Software Testing and Validation
- Black-box and White-box Testing
- Introduction to Automated Analysis
- Introduction to Software Testing
- Web and Mobile Testing with Selenium

ISTQB CTFL - In Progress

REFERENCES

Yonela Futho | Tech Mentor, CAPACITI | yonela@capaciti.org.za